Katsura Tree

Cercidiphyllum japonicum

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate



Fall color
Library candidate

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 40–60 ft (up to 100 ft in wild). Confirmed by Missouri Botanical (40–60 ft), Oregon State (40–60 ft). × 25–60 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 4–8. Non-native (China, Japan). Medium to large deciduous tree. Heart-shaped leaves, excellent fall color (gold, orange, red), often with burnt-sugar fragrance. Performs well in Atlanta with moisture. Prefers moist well-drained soil. Attractive specimen or shade tree. Moderate growth. Best with some protection from extreme heat/drought when young. Restart pass (2026-10-13): Regional sources confirm moisture preference. Existing notes stand.
Sun: Full sun to part shade. Best with light shade in heat.
Water: Medium. Prefers rich, moist, well-drained. Little drought tolerance when young. Needs supplemental water.
Soil: Rich, moist, well-drained preferred. Adaptable pH. Better fall color in acid soils.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in rich moist well-drained soil. Water regularly until established and in dry periods. Suitable as specimen or shade tree. Attractive foliage and fall color. Minimal pruning. Good for Atlanta landscapes with moisture.
Soil prep: Rich, moist, well-drained preferred. Adaptable pH. Better fall color in acid soils.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: China and Japan. Understory tree in native range.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Medium to large tree. Pyramidal when young, rounded dense. Single or multi-trunked. Moderate growth.
Foliage: Gold, orange, red. Excellent. Often fragrant.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Gray-brown, developing with age. Can split.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally durable. Possible bark splitting or sunscald. Leaf damage from late frost. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence thin. No serious problems stated.
Not stated
Additional:
- Heart-shaped leaves. - Excellent fall color with fragrance. - Attractive form. - Multi-trunked often. - Best with moisture. - Dioecious.